10 MINUTES A DAY

Intimate Pilates
Strong Pelvic Floor



Pelvic floor exercises to stop bladder leaks, firm your belly and boost intimacy.

WALL PILATES · 21-DAY CHALLENGE

The muscle no one introduced you to

The **pelvic floor** is a group of muscles at the base of your pelvis, like a hammock that supports your bladder, uterus and bowel. Pregnancy, childbirth, the hormonal drop of menopause, constipation and years of straining the wrong way all weaken that hammock.

The most common signs are **bladder leaks** when you cough, sneeze, laugh or jump, a sudden urge to go to the bathroom, a feeling of heaviness down there and less sensation during sex. Bladder leaks are common, but **they are not a normal part of aging**. And pelvic floor training is the first recommendation for these cases.

> See an OB-GYN or a pelvic floor physical therapist if you have pain, bleeding, a feeling of a "bulge" coming out of the vagina, recurring urinary tract infections or if you recently gave birth.

Find your pelvic floor

1. Sit on a sturdy chair with your feet on the floor.
2. Imagine you're holding in gas and, at the same time, pee.
3. You should feel your pelvic area close and lift slightly inward.
4. Your butt, thighs and belly should stay relaxed.

> **Didn't feel anything?**
>
> Lie on your side and place your hand on your perineum, between the vagina and the anus, over your clothes. When you squeeze, you'll feel the area lift away from your hand. This is normal at first: your awareness improves within a few days of training.

The Intimate Routine (10 minutes)

Do them in order, ideally at the same time each day

1	Lateral breathing against the wall	**1 minute**
2	Slow pelvic floor squeeze	**10 reps of 5 seconds**
3	Quick squeezes (flicks)	**10 flicks**
4	Pelvic tilt with feet on the wall	**10 reps**
5	Bridge with feet on the wall	**10 reps, squeezing your pelvic floor on the way up**
6	The elevator	**5 rides up**
7	Clamshell with feet on the wall	**10 per side**
8	Legs up the wall	**1 minute relaxing everything**

Relaxing is just as important as squeezing: a muscle that can't relax doesn't work well either.

The exercises, step by step

Slow pelvic floor squeeze

Pelvic floor

Position: Lying on your back, knees bent, feet on the floor and hands on your belly.

1. Breathe in through your nose and relax your belly and pelvic area.
2. As you breathe out, close and draw your pelvic area in and up, as if holding in pee and gas at the same time.
3. Hold the squeeze for 3 to 10 seconds, breathing normally.
4. Fully release for the same amount of time you held before the next rep.

Breathing: Squeeze as you breathe out and never hold your breath during the squeeze.

Avoid: Squeezing your butt, thighs or belly instead of your pelvic floor. Not relaxing between reps.

Easier version: Hold for just 3 seconds and do 5 reps.

Safety: Don't use this exercise to stop your pee mid-stream: that interferes with emptying your bladder.

Quick squeezes (flicks)

Pelvic floor

Position: Lying down, sitting or standing, depending on the week of the plan.

1. Squeeze your pelvic area strongly and quickly, like a blink.
2. Fully release right after.
3. Repeat at a pace of about one flick per second.

Breathing: Breathe normally, without holding your breath.

Avoid: Doing half-squeezes because you're rushing. Forgetting to fully release between flicks.

Easier version: Do 5 flicks and rest 10 seconds before 5 more.

Safety: If you feel pelvic pain, stop and see a pelvic floor physical therapist.

The elevator

Pelvic floor | Transverse abdominis

Position: Sitting on a sturdy chair, feet on the floor and spine long.

1. Imagine your pelvic area is an elevator on the ground floor.
2. Squeeze a little and rise to the 1st floor. Hold 2 seconds.
3. Squeeze more and rise to the 2nd floor. Hold 2 seconds.
4. Squeeze as hard as you can and reach the 3rd floor. Hold 2 seconds.
5. Come down floor by floor until you fully release on the ground floor.

Breathing: Breathe in short, calm breaths on the way up, without holding your breath.

Avoid: Lifting your shoulders or clenching your belly hard.

Easier version: Use only two floors.

Safety: Control matters more than strength: go up and down slowly.

Pelvic tilt with feet on the wall

10 reps

Transverse abdominis | Rectus abdominis | Pelvic floor

Position: Lying on your back, hips close to the wall, knees bent at 90° and feet resting on the wall.

1. Start with a neutral spine: a small space between your lower back and the floor.
2. As you exhale, tuck your pelvis so your lower back touches the floor.
3. As you inhale, slowly return to neutral.
4. Keep your feet pressing lightly and steadily into the wall.

Breathing: Exhale as you tuck your pelvis, inhale as you return.

Avoid: Using your glutes to push instead of your abs. Holding your breath.

Easier version: Make the movement smaller: even a tiny tilt activates your deep core.

Safety: The movement should feel comfortable for your lower back; don't force the range.

Bridge with feet on the wall

10 reps

Gluteus maximus | Hamstrings | Abs

Position: Lying on your back, knees bent at 90°, feet on the wall hip-width apart.

1. Arms by your sides, palms down.
2. Press your feet into the wall and lift your hips until you form a line from shoulders to knees.
3. Hold for a second at the top, squeezing your glutes.
4. Lower down one vertebra at a time.

Breathing: Exhale as you lift, inhale as you lower.

Avoid: Arching your lower back at the top. Letting your knees drift apart.

Easier version: Lift only halfway and lower slowly.

Safety: Your weight stays on your shoulders, never on your neck.

Clamshell with feet on the wall

10 per side

Gluteus medius | Hip rotators

Position: Lying on your side, back and hips aligned, knees bent and feet resting on the wall.

1. Rest your head on your bottom arm.
2. Keeping your feet together and on the wall, open your top knee like a clamshell.
3. Close slowly. Then switch sides.

Breathing: Exhale as you open, inhale as you close.

Avoid: Rolling your hips back. Taking your feet off the wall.

Easier version: Open your knee less.

Safety: Keep your hips stacked, one on top of the other, the whole time.

The lock: the trick against leaks

Before you cough, sneeze, laugh, lift something or get up from a chair, **squeeze your pelvic floor one second beforehand** and hold it during the effort. With practice, it becomes automatic and leaks decrease within the first few weeks.

4-week plan

Week	Position	Slow squeeze	Flicks
1	Lying down	10 x 3 seconds	10
2	Lying down and seated	10 x 5 seconds	15

Week	Position	Slow squeeze	Flicks
3	Seated	10 x 8 seconds	20
4	Standing	10 x 10 seconds	20 + the lock with every effort

After the 4 weeks, keep the routine going at least 3 times a week. Results usually become clear between 6 and 12 weeks.

More strength, more pleasure

Strong pelvic floor muscles with good blood flow are linked to **more sensation** and reaching orgasm more easily. Knowing and controlling this area also brings more confidence in intimacy. During sex, try squeezing and relaxing slowly.

Habits that protect your pelvic floor

- **Don't hold your pee for hours**, but don't go "just in case" all the time either.
- **Don't strain on the toilet.** Use a small stool under your feet and load up on fiber and water.
- **When lifting things,** breathe out and use the lock.
- **Avoid too much coffee and soda**, which irritate the bladder.
- **Keep a healthy weight:** extra belly weight increases pressure on your pelvis.

Leak diary

Week	Leaks per day (average)	In what situation	How I feel
1			
2			
3			
4			

Daily checklist

- [ ] I did the Intimate Routine
- [ ] I drank water throughout the day
- [ ] I used the lock when coughing or lifting
- [ ] I ate fiber

- [ ] I relaxed my pelvic floor at the end of the workout

This material is educational and does not replace guidance from a doctor, dietitian or certified fitness professional. If you have any health condition, are pregnant, postpartum or feel pain, talk to a professional before starting and always respect your body's limits.